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W E D N E S D A Y , S E P T E M B E R 3 , 2 0 2 5

At Harvard, he wrote of Hitler and provoked

Now a lawyer with Trump team, Velchik argues that school allowed antisemitism

By **Hilary Burns and Tal Kopan**

GLOBE STAFF

The cornerstone of the Trump administration's justification for cracking down on Harvard University is that the Ivy League school has allegedly allowed antisemitism to fester on campus.

"The choice was made, let's not give federal taxpayer dollars to institutions that exhibit a

wanton indifference to antisemitism," the lawyer defending the government's case said in federal court in July.

Yet that lawyer, Michael Velchik, when he was a senior at Harvard 14 years ago, submitted a paper for a Latin class written from the perspective of Adolf Hitler, according to three people studying in the department with knowledge of the incident. The

VELCHICK, Page A6



JIM HARRISON/FILE

Michael Velchik gave the Latin Oration at Harvard's commencement ceremony in 2012.

Ruling could put brake on Trump's cities plans

Judge says troops have been used too expansively

By **Charlie Savage**

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — A federal judge's ruling that President Trump has been using troops illegally to perform

NEWS ANALYSIS

law enforcement functions in Los Angeles will — if it stands — pose impediments to any plans Trump may have for

sending the military into the streets of other cities, including Chicago.

Trump has made those threats in the context of his anti-crime operation in Washington, D.C., which has involved both civilian federal agents and National Guard troops under federal control. But because the District of Columbia is not a state, the

federal government has greater latitude to use the Guard there.

The Posse Comitatus Act, enacted in 1878, makes it illegal to use federal troops for domestic policing under normal circumstances. So to keep from running afoul of that law, Trump would need a legal rationale for deploying troops to cities including

TRUMP, Page A6

With hybrid schedules a fact of life, **downtown still has miles to go**



ONE IN FOUR downtown office spaces — close to 10 million square feet — remain empty, and commuter rail ridership has softened. No big changes in workers' schedules have been announced for September.

SUZANNE KREITER/
GLOBE STAFF

Boston's central business district has far fewer apartments than similar downtowns in other cities.

By **Jon Chesto**

GLOBE STAFF

Mitchell Baratz had his hopes up when he learned Amazon was bringing office workers back five days a week. He got even more excited when JPMorgan Chase said it would do something similar.

Milk Street Cafe's chief operating officer thought other big employers in Boston would follow. Nine months later, few if any have done so.

So Baratz is still waiting for that next wave of workers. Mid-week sales and catering volume at the cafe, a block from Post Of-

fice Square, are about three-quarters of prepandemic levels, slower on Mondays, and dismal on Fridays. Weekly revenue is around 60 percent of prepandemic levels. As a result, his staff is down to 55 from 75 six years ago.

"We thought Amazon was the first domino," Baratz said. "But then, not really. . . . We would love to have more business. Honestly, it's at the point where Fridays are boring."

Ever since offices reopened in the pandemic, businesspeople have wondered when the "new normal" would arrive. Office employers typically started with one or two days a week in the office.

DOWNTOWN, Page A7

Immigrant families have the talk as ICE lurks

By **Marcela Rodrigues**

GLOBE STAFF

NEW BEDFORD — Instead of excitement for her first year of high school, 14-year-old Suri Colón Diego can't sleep most nights. Fear creeps into her thoughts as she worries about ICE breaking her family apart.

What if they take me? What if they take my classmates? What

if they take you? What am I going to do without you, mami?

Her mother, Mexican native Edith Colón Diego, is consistently trying to answer Suri's questions. This is all new to the teen, who didn't think about her mother's immigration status until this year.

"Sometimes, I'm like, 'Oh my God, what do I say?' Sometimes

there are questions I don't even have answers to," Diego said in Spanish.

As ICE ramps up operations across the country and deportations reach a new high of nearly 1,500 people per day, immigrant families such as the Diegos are having frank discussions about their immigration status in the United States, the process to ob-

tain citizenship, the agents arresting community members in their neighborhood, and their emergency plan in case one of them is detained or deported.

Schools no longer are "sensitive locations" protected from immigration enforcement, as they were in previous presidential administrations, prompting

DEPORTATION, Page A5

Judge rules for O'Brien in battle with Goldberg

Calling evidence thin, he reinstates her to pot panel

By **Diti Kohli and Matt Stout**

GLOBE STAFF

A Suffolk County judge on Tuesday ruled the state treasurer wrongly fired Shannon O'Brien as chair of the state's Cannabis Control Commission, and ordered O'Brien reinstated immediately, adding another twist to the drama and dysfunction that have marked the agency that regulates Massachusetts' marijuana industry.

In an often pointed ruling, Suffolk Superior Court Judge Robert B. Gordon said that while O'Brien may have made "concededly ill-considered remarks" during her first year

chairing the commission, her conduct fell far short of the legal bar for "gross misconduct" that Treasurer Deborah Goldberg cited, and the law required, to remove her from her post.

He likened Goldberg's evidence for firing O'Brien to a house of cards and "thin gruel," and said O'Brien should be reinstated to finish her five-year term following what he called a "Dickensian drama" that has dragged out for nearly two years.

"A Sword of Damocles does not hang over every commissioner who berates staff or makes foolish, tin-eared or even offensive remarks to them," Gordon wrote in his 50-page decision. "If that were the case, the independence and

O'BRIEN, Page A7

Over 85 scientists condemned a Trump administration report that calls the threat of climate change overblown. **A2.**

Ukraine is pursuing a multibillion-dollar arms buildup, seeing it as the best chance of ensuring long-term survival. **A3.**

Double take

Wednesday: Sunny again. High 72-77. Low 56-61.

Thursday: And again. High 75-80. Low 64-69.

Sunrise: 6:12 Sunset: 7:15

Weather and Comics, G6-7.



Nothing fancy here

Family dinners can be simple (cottage cheese wraps, and a pasta and corn dish), as long as they bring everyone together. **G1.**

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